

LEAVE POLICY 2026

This policy applies to all full-time employees of Acme Technologies Pvt Ltd in India. It is effective from 1 January 2026 and replaces earlier leave policies. Leave is applied for and approved in the HR system. HR owns this policy and reviews it every year.

1. Annual leave

Every full-time employee earns 18 days of annual leave per calendar year, credited at 1.5 days per month. Employees who join during the year earn annual leave from their joining month.

Annual leave must be applied for at least 7 calendar days in advance. Requests of up to 5 working days with enough balance and enough notice are approved automatically. Longer requests, or requests with short notice, need the manager's approval.

Up to 6 unused days can be carried forward to the next year. Days above that lapse on 31 December unless the leave was refused for business reasons, in which case HR may allow them to be carried forward for one more quarter.

2. Sick leave

Employees get 8 days of paid sick leave per year. Sick leave needs no advance notice, but the employee should tell their manager before the start of the working day.

Absences of more than 2 consecutive working days need a medical certificate, uploaded within 3 days of returning to work. Unused sick leave does not carry forward and is not encashed.

3. Casual leave

Employees get 6 days of casual leave per year for personal matters. Casual leave can be taken for at most 2 consecutive days and should be applied for at least 1 day in advance.

Casual leave cannot be combined with annual leave in the same stretch. Unused casual leave lapses at the end of the year.

4. Public holidays and weekends

The company follows the published holiday calendar for the employee's work location. Public holidays and weekends falling inside a leave period are not counted as leave days.

5. Maternity leave

Maternity leave is 26 weeks of paid leave for the first two children, as per the Maternity Benefit Act. From the third child it is 12 weeks. Up to 8 weeks can be taken before the expected date of delivery. Employees adopting a child below three months of age get 12 weeks.

After maternity leave, employees can work from home for up to 6 months where the role allows it, by agreement with their manager.

6. Paternity leave

Paternity leave is 10 working days, to be taken within 3 months of the child's birth or adoption. It can be taken in at most two parts.

7. Bereavement leave

Employees get 5 days of paid bereavement leave on the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling or parent-in-law). No advance notice is needed.

8. Marriage leave

Employees get 3 days of paid marriage leave once during their employment, for their own wedding. It must be taken within 1 month of the wedding date.

9. Compensatory off

An employee asked by their manager to work on a weekend or public holiday earns one compensatory day off for each full day worked. A compensatory off must be used within 60 days or it lapses.

10. Loss of pay

Leave taken without enough balance is treated as loss of pay. Loss of pay is deducted at one thirtieth of the monthly gross salary for each day. Unauthorised absence for more than 3 consecutive days is handled under the code of conduct.

11. Leave encashment

Annual leave can be encashed only at separation, up to 30 days, at the basic salary rate. Sick and casual leave are never encashed.

12. Applying for and approving leave

Leave is applied for in the HR system or through the HR assistant. The reporting manager approves leave. If the manager is away for more than 2 working days, the request goes to the manager's own manager. HR can see every request and may cancel leave booked against the rules.